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Brandeis was warned of shuttle dangers

Student passenger recounted to school of ‘fearing for my life’ before fatal crash

By Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

One student anonymously complained of “fearing for my life” while riding a Brandeis University shuttle bus and accused the driver of operating erratically. A separate report involved a door that opened while

the bus was in motion.

Those complaints were lodged with Brandeis campus police in the weeks before a university shuttle bus crashed in Waltham nearly three years ago, killing a 25-year-old woman and seriously injuring others, according to new court filings.

The warnings, which university officials discussed during depositions earlier this year, prompted a Suffolk Superior Court judge to rule Aug. 6 that Brandeis and its public safety leader, Matthew Rushton, could be sued for negligence in connection with the fatal crash.

“This tragedy was preventable. Brandeis was warned about dangerous drivers, repeated safety complaints, and buses without seatbelts

but they did nothing,” Walter Kelley, a lawyer for several injured passengers, said in a statement late last month. “Brandeis ignored all of the red flags and the result was catastrophic. That’s not an accident, that’s negligence — and we are going to make sure they are held accountable.”

In a statement, the university said late last month that the crash

BRANDEIS, Page A7

Massive air attack hits heart of Kyiv

Government building set ablaze; calls intensify for stiffer sanctions on Moscow

By Siobhán O’Grady
and Serhiy Morgunov
WASHINGTON POST

KYIV — Russia unleashed its largest-ever air assault on Ukraine early Sunday, sending more than 800 drones and 13 missiles into the country in an hourslong attack that set the main government building in Kyiv ablaze for the first time during the war.

A Russian drone also struck a residential building in the capital, killing at least three people, including a mother and her infant son. At least 20 other people were wounded in Kyiv, officials said.

The morning attack sent residents running to bomb shelters as plumes of smoke rose over the city center. The assault marked the largest number of Russian drones sent into Ukraine in a single day and continued a worrying trend of increased Russian attacks on the center of the capital, following another major strike on Kyiv last week.

“Such killings now, when real diplomacy could already have begun, are a deliberate crime and an attempt to prolong the war,” Ukrainian President

UKRAINE, Page A10



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

A DANK, DREARY DOWNER OF A DEBUT

Expectations for the New England Patriots were high for the start of their season Sunday but quarterback Drake Maye (above, after a Raiders sack) and the rest of his teammates were laid low by the Las Vegas Raiders. The result, a 20-13 loss, left damp Gillette Stadium fans dispirited. **C1.**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Two programs linked to the Boston area bring budding Palestinian and Israeli entrepreneurs together. D1.

Dr. David Baltimore died. The former MIT professor earned the Nobel Prize for a discovery that upended the foundation of molecular biology. **B6.**

Governor Maura Healey decried the expanded immigration enforcement in the state. **B1.**

Nicholas Mitropoulos died. The consummate campaign insider helped politicians from Thomas Menino and Michelle Wu to Bill Clinton win elections. **B1.**

For Trump, politics and sports do mix

From golf to UFC, he relishes spotlight and wields influence

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Anyone watching the US Open tennis men’s final Sunday in New York City and hoping to escape politics was out of luck.

President Trump was in attendance at Arthur Ashe Stadium, the latest in a string of major sporting events he’s attended during his second term. That includes becoming the first sitting president to attend the Super Bowl in February.

►Carlos Alcaraz dominated top-ranked Jannik Sinner, winning the US Open in four sets. **C1.**

The seven months since have been full of sports-related executive orders, announcement ceremonies, Oval Office visits, and social media hot takes.

Trump has asserted his dominance over politics, higher education, and corporations in the US from his presidential perch. Sports

— long perceived as a refuge from more divisive aspects of American life — is another venue he is trying to influence.

“Where most presidents have tried to use sports to unite a divided nation, he uses them to press a political advantage,” said Tom Knecht, a political science professor at Westmont College who runs a blog dedicated to the convergence of politics and sports. “He is much more parti-

TRUMP, Page A6

The hunt for homes takes a detour south

Fall River region boasts affordability

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF

MATTAPOISETT — Carolyn Simcoe was once a Bostonian, but she moved to Quincy and then with her husband to Plymouth, in search of lower rents and more space. Ultimately, though, they had to move even farther south, to Mattapoisett, to find a house that they loved and could actually afford to buy.

“We moved further and further from Boston as we were getting into our 30s,” she said.

The couple is among a cohort of aspiring Massachusetts homeown-

ers who have cast their eyes on the South Coast to finally get a place of their own or find something better than what is available to them in places like Boston.

Southeastern Massachusetts counties are seeing a higher pace of home sales compared to the Greater Boston area, said Asad Khan, a Boston-based senior economist at the real estate brokerage Redfin.

As of July 2025, homes sales in Bristol, which runs from Easton south to Horseneck Beach, were up more than 6 percent compared with the same time a year ago, while Plymouth County, where Mattapoisett is located, was up more than 2 percent. Norfolk County, home to

SOUTH COAST, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Carolyn Simcoe and her husband, Paul, migrated away from Boston through several stops before landing in their new home in Mattapoisett.

Justices’ ruling on use of race in admissions still divides

Asian Americans search for answers amid diversity shift

By Jessica Ma
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Kathryn Kyomitmaitee knows what makes Harvard University special: a diverse community.

But since June 2023, after the US Supreme Court struck down race-conscious college admissions, and more recently amid attacks on Harvard by President Trump, Kyomitmaitee has found herself wondering how to preserve that diversity.

“If you strike down affirmative action, you are [creating] implications about what diversity on campuses will look like,” said Kyomitmaitee, a Thai American Harvard senior who organized protests to champion affirmative action two summers ago. “Now, with the current air and tension that is on campus with the crackdowns, it’s definitely reverberating.”

Two years after the Students for Fair Admissions v. Harvard ruling — a case brought by Asian American plaintiffs aggrieved by college admis-

AFFIRMATIVE ACTION, Page A7

1.4%
increase in Asian American enrollment in the class of 2028 across 30 universities, compared to the average for the classes of 2026 and 2027



Replenishing your sol

Monday: Sun returns, pleasant. High 70-75, low 55-60.

Tuesday: Partly sunny, nice. High 66-71, low 55-60

Sunrise: 6:17. Sunset: 7:06

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **B6.**

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